

Chief Cohen Has B's in Hollywood Bonnet

By LESTER KOELLING
News SportsWriter

HOLLYWOOD, Fla.—“Whatever you write, please refer to us as the Indianapolis B team.”

Those were the first words coming our way on arriving here in this new spring training camp of the Indianapolis Indians. It was Manager Andy Cohen's way of saying “we need help, and plenty of it.”



Koelling

The roster almost tells you that of the 28 players now officially checked in, only about eight figure to remain with the Tribe for the opening of the American Association season. The “plenty of help” is due to come from the Chicago White Sox, with whom the Indians have a working agreement this year.

“But darn it all,” lamented Cohen, “the fellows we were figuring on most are going great guns for the White Sox. That means we won't get 'em until later, if at all.”

Cohen had specific reference to Jim Landis, an outfielder; Tom Brown, an infielder, and Earl Battey, a catcher with Charleston two years ago.

Aside from the frowns caused by the lack of experienced talent, Cohen's face is wreathed in smiles.

“This is the best minor league setup I've seen in all my years of baseball,” he says, “and the weather has been great, positively great.”

One could easily tell that from the heavily tanned figures immediately recognized as ball players, even though everyone was a stranger except Teddy Beard.

“We have great spirit on this club,” beamed Cohen. “The boys are supposed to be at the park at 10 o'clock. But most of them are there half-an-hour before that time. And our so-called veterans? You should see Beard, (Al) Papai and (Tony) Ponce working. They do everything the kids do and just as long.”

“Yeah,” came a sound from the rear. “I did more sliding in that pit today than I've done in 18 years of baseball. Now I know how to slide.”

The voice was that of Papai, knuckleball righthander bought by Indianapolis from Memphis where he had a 20-10 record last season.

“But he can't run as fast as me,” barked another voice, this one belonging to Ponce, who, as a member of Louisville early last season, gave the Indians fits at the plate. “I do believe I'm faster now than ever—running, not pitching.”

Louisville sold Ponce to Miami in midseason and the Indians bought him from the Marlins last winter. Ponce also is a knuckleballer, and when he and Papai met for the first time down here, Cohen says they had a tough time shaking hands.

A two-game series with the University of Miami nine has been arranged for the “Indianapolis B Team.” The first game was to be played there today and the second here tomorrow. The Miamians are coached by Jimmy Foxx, one of yesterday's noted major league sluggers.

“We'll put some kind of a team together,” said Cohen, who lacks a first baseman and a shortstop and who has only rookies for the outfield.

The Tribe's regular exhibition schedule will start Monday against Buffalo, and Cohen just “hopes they're in the same predicament that we are.”

Johnny Logan, star Milwaukee shortstop, may have been thinking of WES COVINGTON

the other day when he suggested that Milwaukee's pennant chances would brighten considerably “if the guys in left field” would improve their batting averages. Anyhow, Covington socked three homers yesterday as did Logan, each driving in five runs as the Braves overpowered the Chicago White Sox, 10-7.

The Cincinnati Redlegs, who drubbed the New York Yankees, 20-6, Wednesday with 25 hits, collected 22 against Philadelphia, including a homer by Hal Bevan, to win 13-10 yesterday.

A triple by EDDIE BRES-SOUD with a mate aboard, and a sacrifice fly broke up a scoreless game in the seventh between the New York Giants and the Baltimore Orioles. New York won, 2-1.

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